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This attractive tapestry bag with cord shoulder strap is the perfect accessory for the party season. Inside—Lancôme's new and exciting fragrance, 'Magie Noire' eau de toilette spray. An irresistible duo for gift giving and wonderful value at David Jones exclusively. While stocks last, so be sure to take early advantage.



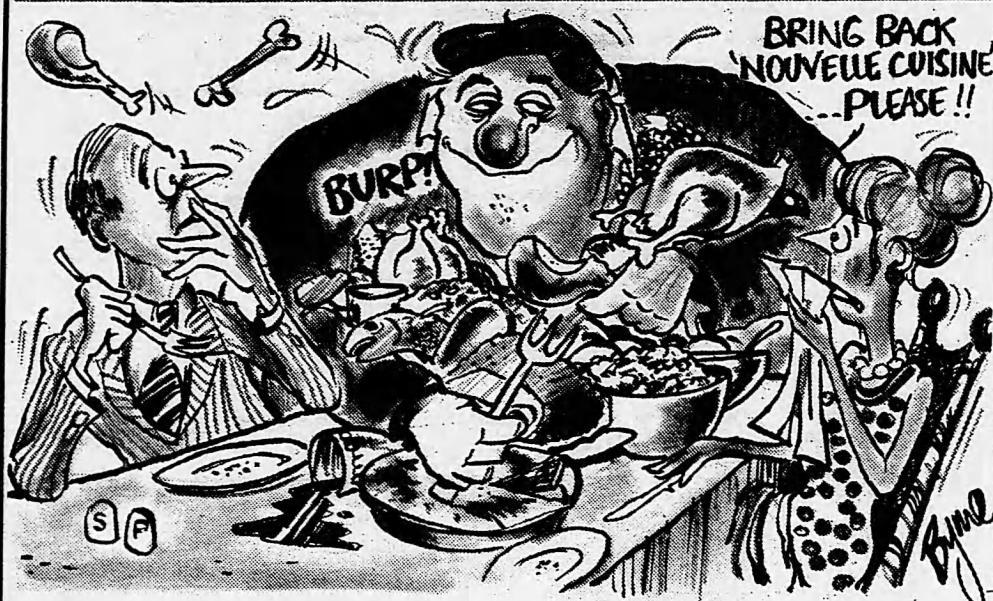
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tempo

Maybe now we can farewell 'nouvelle'



GOOD grief! Would you believe that at last the Poms are rebelling against the tyranny of the French?

Someone has had the fearless, Churchillian courage to stand up for those of us who are traditional, comfortable and greedy.

The new edition of Britain's most revered restaurant and hotel guide *Egon Ronay's Lucas Guide 1985* says Nouvelle Cuisine is out and good old style cooking is back in fashion.

With superb courage the Guide says: "Nouvelle cuisine, its importance disproportionately overstated, is mercifully on the wane and we can all start using our teeth again, instead of dutifully munching interminable mousses, kiwi fruit and intentionally lukewarm bits of meat or liver incongruously strewn on salads.

"Good old-style cooking is coming back — as indeed it is in France — to satisfy our stomachs not our intellect."

Nouvelle Cuisine was pioneered by Fernand Point in the 1950s. The theory was that French food was designed for the era of Louise XIV, lavish use of butter, joyous use of cream, devoted passionate lardings of sugar, exquisite layers of pastry plus scrumptious sauces even richer than Marie Antoinette. M. Point finished all that with a lighter, so called simpler style of cooking, using fine natural ingredients.

Then circa 1978, along came Michel Guerard with *Cuisine Minceur*. This was a sort of super Nouvelle Cuisine, French cooking without the calories, M. Guerard even went so far as to say (shudder), that one shouldn't drink more than one glass of wine with one's meal.



He wrote that one night he awakened in a terrible sweat: "My poor body, heavy with the residue of so many rich and delectable sauces, was so well covered that it weighed me to the ground, where dreams cannot take flight. Round my waist the centimetres had covered a considerable distance ..."

So Michel invented his style of French cooking and it swept the world. It went into every would-be Continental restaurant from Brooklyn to Collins Street. At last you could go into a beautiful establishment, pay \$50 a head and still come out half starved.

Many a noble house I have entered, received the main course, sat back confidently with the thought: "They'll bring the vegetables soon." But they never come. What you have received already is a work of art.

Nouvelle Cuisine and Cuisine Minceur meant that every plate had to be a work of art, a still life, a Picasso, a Chagall, a Utrillo. I mean you would get your breast of chicken or duck in the centre, two spears of asparagus at two o'clock, a fan of snow peas at four o'clock, a single strawberry still sporting its green tuft on top, a slice of avocado at nine o'clock and a sprig of some exotic herb at noon.

You have to wait for your dishes. It can take half an hour to arrange the perfect work of art.

The chef, host or hostess devoted to this style of cooking couldn't just go to the market and load up with any old thing.

KEITH DUNSTAN celebrates the return of REAL food

You have to think of the picture. Ideally things need to be small and you have to pick over the barrow for the right shape. Zucchini must be perfect. God needs to have designed it correctly for slicing: snow peas should be small and even so that they can be arranged into a little fan.

You can't have vulgar fat tomatoes, you should have the charming little cherry tomatoes, they fit so much better into the design.

You never eat fish unless there is a nice, correctly shaped piece of dill alongside.

What's more, never would you make a salad out of plain old lettuce. It is essential that the Cuisine Minceur person keep coming up with things that are different.

It might have French sorrel, a few delicate spinach leaves, and glory be, lettuce that is unusual, say, Romaine or butter lettuce which costs twice as much as other types of lettuce.

You don't pour sauces all over your food any more. It is essential that you have a "coulis" which goes underneath, a divine backdrop for the noble creations on top.

Decorations are all the go. Your fish dish, your cheese platter or tiny dessert can be enlivened with a dandelion, an African violet or even a small orchid.

Herbs too. I don't think Mother ever used anything beyond parsley, mint and horse radish, but you gotta have the herb of the week, preferably something nobody else can identify.

Your fresh piece of herb is the ultimate decoration — tansy, hyssop, or melissa officinalis, better known as lemon balm. The other day we had our dessert delightfully offset with a sprig of comfrey. In the old days this was considered just the thing for soothing open wounds.

Sometimes in a bland moment you might get the idea that the herb is there for human consumption. Be careful. You don't want your mouth to be an open wound.

Of course, desserts are not what they used to be, you get minute crepes, tiny tarts, delicate little fruit souffles on their inevitable coulis.

Ice creams, vanilla? Certainly not. They have to be the latest taste sensation, kiwi fruit, mango, ginger. . .

So where will the Brits go now? Will they sweep the world with a new style of cooking. We could call it "Wanton Waistline."

I think of all those half forgotten pre-minceur wonders — thick roast beef with magnificent Yorkshire pudding, brains in bread crumbs and, oh joy, tripe and onions.

How about chicken pie, beef Wellington, rhubarb pie, strawberry pie, steak and kidney pudding with a splendid depth of puffy suet on top. Think of trifle, chocolate blamange and cream, known locally as Yarra mud; think of fish and chips wrapped in the *News of the World*, think of meat fritters in gorgeous batter, apple shortcake, bubble and squeak . . .

How could the world resist it?
I had better stop. I think you're crying.